

PM CASE STUDY · NEWME · 0 → 1

Trend Coins

Turning one-time buyers into repeat customers — without discounting our way there.

The starting point: retention was low and repeat purchase minimal — most users bought once and never returned. Growth ran on new acquisition and sale-day discounts, both expensive. My brief as PM: build a reason to come back that protects margin.

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Why a coin economy, not more discounts

Diagnosing the retention problem showed four linked issues — one system could address all of them.



One-and-done buyers

No reason to return after the first order — LTV capped at order #1.



Discount-trained users

Purchases clustered around sales. Every retention win burned margin.



COD-heavy orders

High RTO and cancellations — we needed a pull toward prepaid.



Silence between orders

Zero engagement touchpoints between purchases to build a habit on.

The bet: one unified currency — earned on actions we cared about, redeemed at checkout. Explored streaks, tiers and scratch cards; chose the simplest model users would instantly get, and one that scales offline.

Every mechanic mapped to a business problem

The economy wasn't gamification for its own sake — each rule existed to move a metric or protect one.



Earn actions chosen by intent, not engagement

Reviews → UGC & trust. Profile completion → personalization data. Purchase coins pegged to order value → bigger baskets. Every earn action fed a metric we already tracked.



50% redemption cap + 10 coins = ₹1

The margin guardrail. Coins subsidise the next purchase instead of becoming a blanket discount — the difference between a loyalty asset and a liability on the P&L.



Visibility at decision points

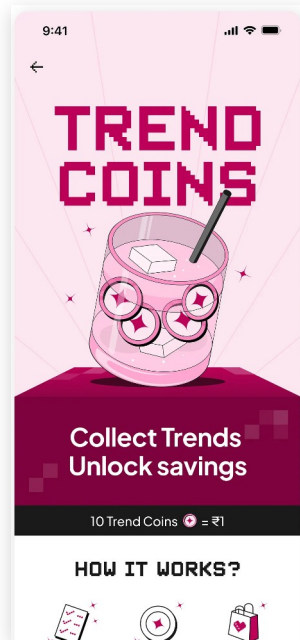
Coins earnable shown on the product page; redemption toggle at checkout. Research said rewards users can't see don't change behaviour — so value appears exactly where decisions happen. Prepaid nudges live here too.



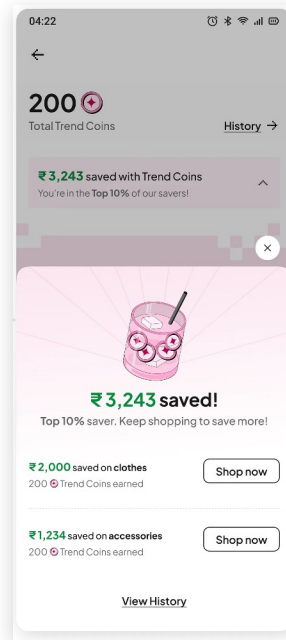
Validated first, then run as an experiment engine

User interviews + benchmarking (Shein, Nykaa, Cider) before build. Post-launch, the economy itself was the test surface: multipliers, prepaid incentives, redemption nudges.

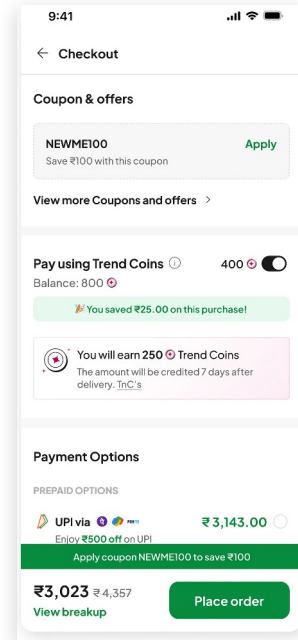
How the decisions showed up in product



A destination, not a wallet — balance, earn actions and mechanics in one hub



Value framed as ₹ saved, not abstract coins — worth made tangible



Redemption at the decision point — savings and earn preview at checkout

What it moved

Measured against M3 retention — the north star the program was built to move.

+8%

M3 retention uplift
(90-day repeat purchase)



Prepaid adoption up

Checkout redemption pulled users off COD — lowering RTO and cancellations.



Order value up

Purchase-pegged coins nudged bigger baskets at the moment of decision.



A permanent lever

Went from a retention fix to standing infrastructure — a tunable economy, not a campaign.

Takeaway: loyalty works when every coin has a job. Design the economics before the delight.